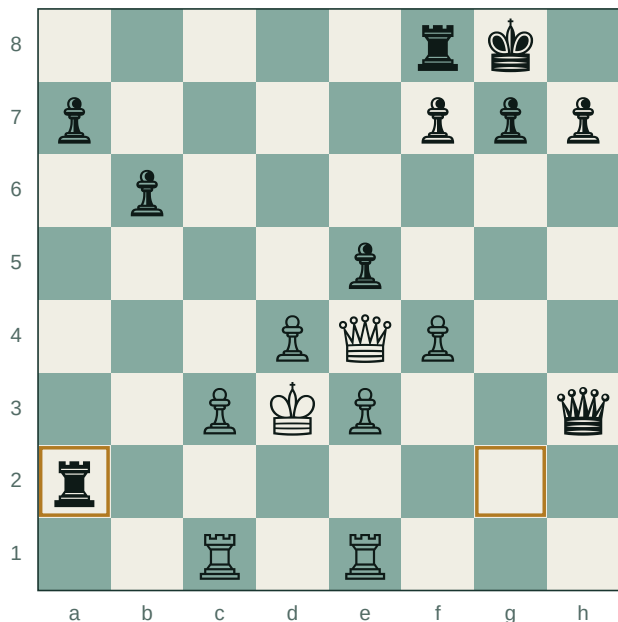


Clearance tactics: White, move 33

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 32...Rxa2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33. Rh1 Rh2 34. Rxh2 Qxh2 35. Rh1 Qxh1 36. Qxh1

33.Rh1 The rook moves from e1 to h1. Recorded reply: **33...Rh2**.

34.Rxh2 The rook captures the rook on h2. Recorded reply: **34...Qxh2**.

35.Rh1 The rook moves from c1 to h1. Recorded reply: **35...Qxh1**.

36.Qxh1 The queen captures the queen on h1.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on h3 and rook on a2. Check for tactical protection.